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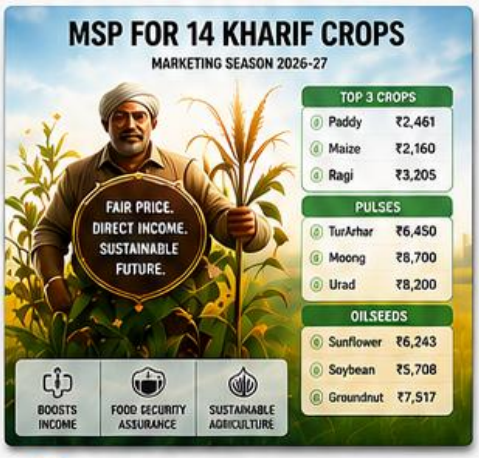
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CURRENT AFFAIRS



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India assumes Vice-Presidency of FATF for the first time; appoints Vivek Agrawal

In June 2025, India was elected as Vice-President of the Financial Task Force (FATF) for the first time. This reflects India's commitment to global standards in combating money laundering and terrorist financing.

Exam Hint:

- **What:** Vice-Presidency of FATF for the first time
- **Who:** Vivek Agrawal
- **Body:** Financial Action Task Force (FATF)
- **Term:** July 2025 to June 2027
- **Significance:** Helps build trust and recognition.

PDF

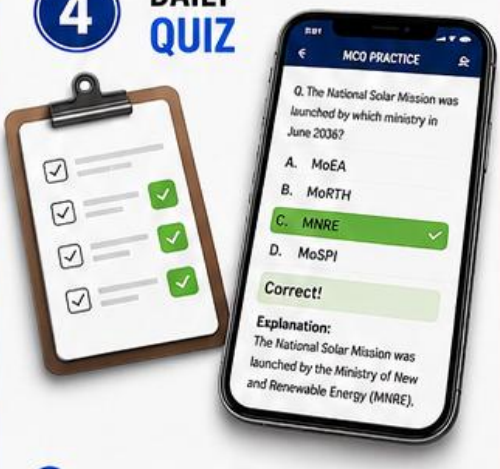
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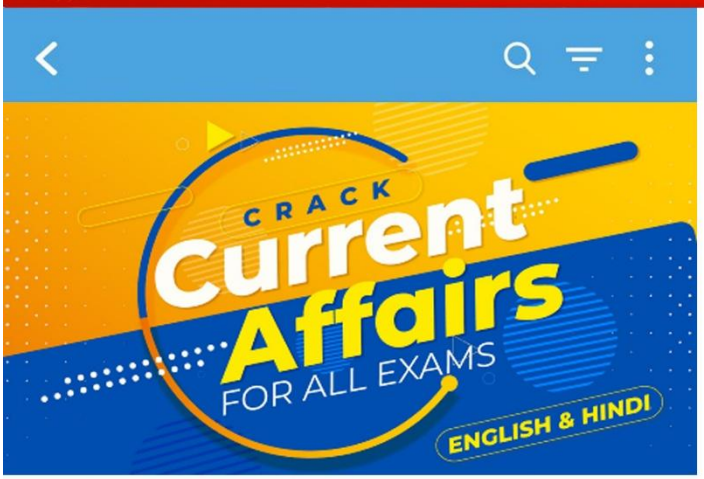
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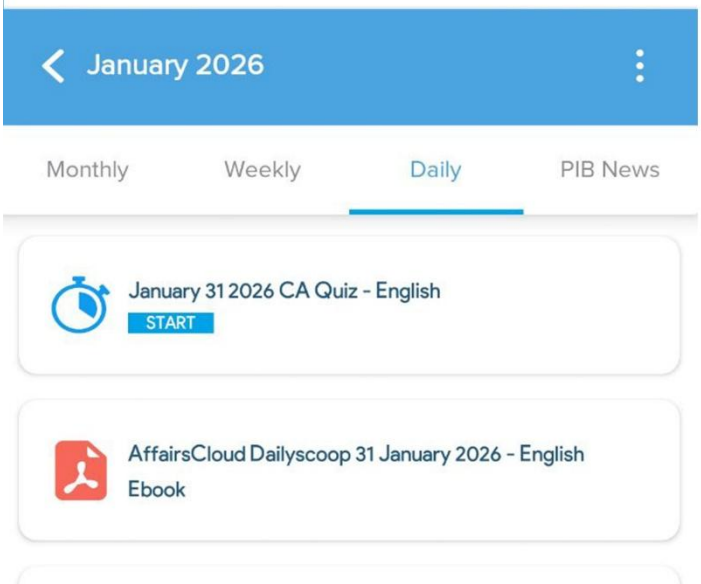
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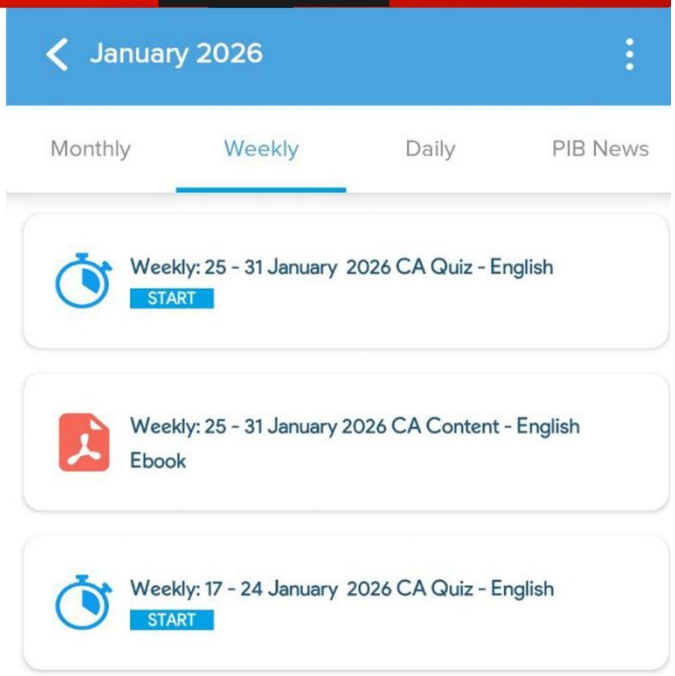
Bank & Insurance

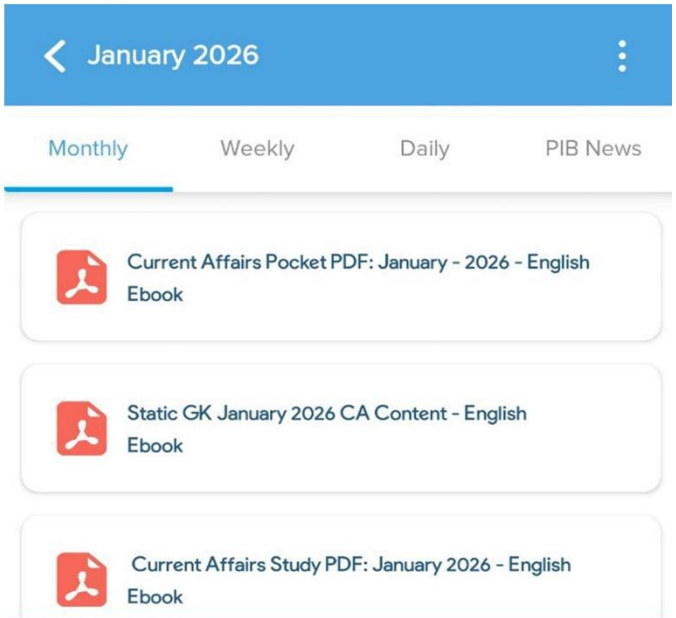
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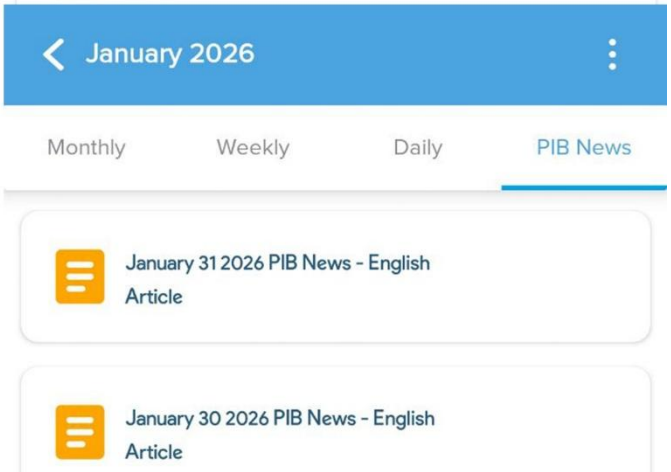
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Table of Contents

HandWritten Notes 5

Detailed Content 14

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HandWritten Notes

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NATIONAL AFFAIRS

1)

India → Re-elected as → ISA President → For → Third Consecutive Term (2026-2028) → Session → 9th ISA Session, Bharat Renewable Energy Summit 2026, New Delhi, Delhi.

ISA President → Co-President → France

- 💰 Fund Support: USD 200 million Africa Fund; USD 300 million Nigeria Fund; India – Rs. 225 crore.
- 🚜 Solar Pumps: 1 million global deployment target under PM-KUSUM.
- 🏝️ Islands & Technology: 500 MW SIDS target by 2030; 17 STAR-Cs, SHINE Centre and AI-enabled ISA Academy.

ISA – International Solar Alliance

PM-KUSUM – Pradhan Mantri Kisan Urja Suraksha evam Utthaan Mahabhiyan

SIDS – Small Island Developing States

MW – Megawatt

STAR-Cs – Solar Technology Application Resource Centres

AI – Artificial Intelligence

INTERNATIONAL AFFAIRS

1)

WIPO → Released → 19th Global Innovation Index (GII) 2026 → Ranked → 139 economies using 79 indicators

Top 5 Countries:

Global Rank	Country Name	Overall Score
1	Switzerland	66.7
2	Sweden	63.2
3	USA	62.3
4	Republic of Korea	61.4
5	Singapore	61.0
38	India	40.1

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📉 Bottom 5: Burundi (135th), Angola (136th), DR Congo (137th), Niger (138th) and Chad (139th, score: 9.5).

🌆 Top Cluster: Bengaluru (Karnataka) – 25th globally, followed by Delhi (27th), Mumbai (Maharashtra) (43rd) and Chennai (Tamil Nadu) (79th).

WIPO – World Intellectual Property Organization

USA – United States of America

2)

Indian Navy (IN) & Royal Navy of Oman (RNO) —Commenced→ Naseem AL Bahr (Sea Breeze)
15th edition of bilateral maritime exercise
↓ Participation
INS Surat
↓ At
Muscat, Oman
8–11 November 2026

🔄 Phases: 2 Phases
- Harbour Phase – professional interactions and cross-deck visits;
- Sea Phase – operational engagements.

🚢 CORPAT: Coordinated Patrol to follow the exercise.

INS – Indian Naval Ship

CORPAT – Coordinated Patrol

JMCC – Joint Military Cooperation Committee

BANKING & FINANCE

1)

🏦 Asian Development Bank (ADB) —Released→ 💰 USD 21.6 Million (First Tranche) —For→ 🛡️ Mizoram Universal Healthcare Scheme (MUHCS) —To→ Focus Affordable & Equitable Healthcare Access

Funding Structure
- 🏦 Loan Component: Rs 20.54 Crore (10%)
- 🎁 Grant Component: Rs 184.93 Crore (90%)

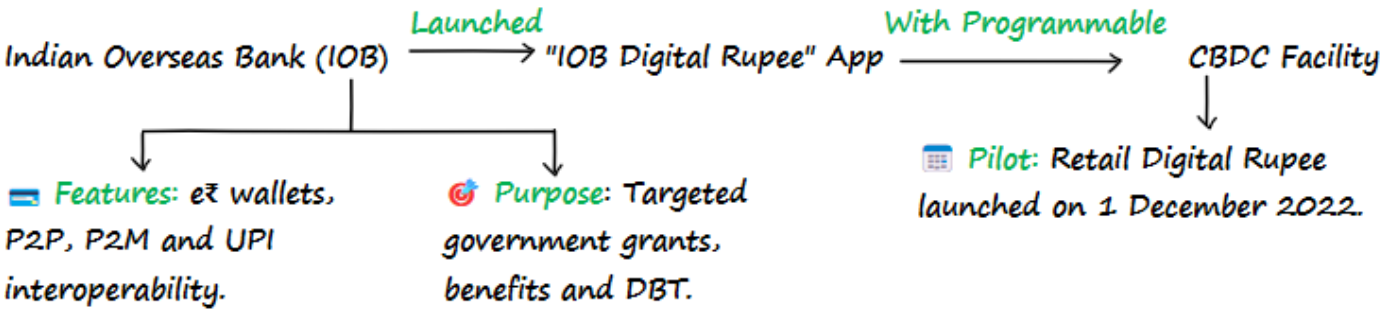
Total Loan:
USD 108 Million (Results-Based)

🏛️ Implementing Agency: Mizoram Finance Department

👥 Beneficiaries: Approximately 1.38 Million Residents

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2)



CBDC – Central Bank Digital Currency

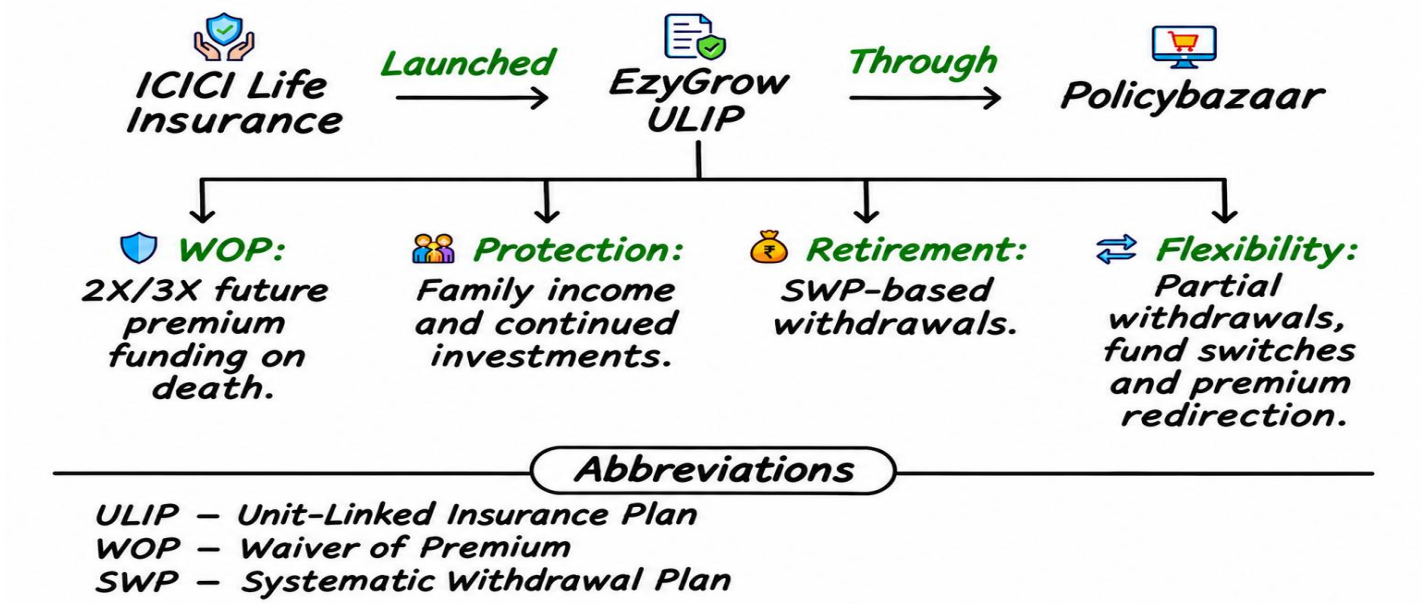
P2P – Peer-to-Peer

P2M – Peer-to-Merchant

UPI – Unified Payments Interface

DBT – Direct Benefit Transfer

3)



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AWARDS & RECOGNITIONS

1)

Dr. Devi Prasad Shetty —Honoured with→ France's 'Knight of the National Order of Merit' —For→ COVID-19 Support

- Award Presented: By Marc Lamy at Bengaluru, Karnataka
- Career: Founded Narayana Hrudayalaya (2001); performed India's first neonatal heart surgery (1992).
- IN National Awards: Karnataka Ratna (2001); Padma Shri (2004) and Padma Bhushan (2012) for contributions to Medicine.
- International Awards: Entrepreneur of the Year (2003, 2012); Economist Innovation Award (2011); IIT Madras honorary D.Sc. (2014).

National Order of Merit:

- Established: 3 December 1963 by Charles de Gaulle.

COVID-19 – Coronavirus Disease 2019

IIT-M – Indian Institute of Technology Madras

D.Sc. – Doctor of Science.

2)

Amit Shah MHA —Conferred→ President's colour to Uttarkhand Police —At→ Dehradun, Uttarakhand

- Occasion: 25th State Formation Day anniversary.
- IN Milestone: 16th state police force to receive the honour.
- First: Indian Navy (IN) received the President colour on 27 May 1951.

MHA – Ministry of Home Affairs

3)



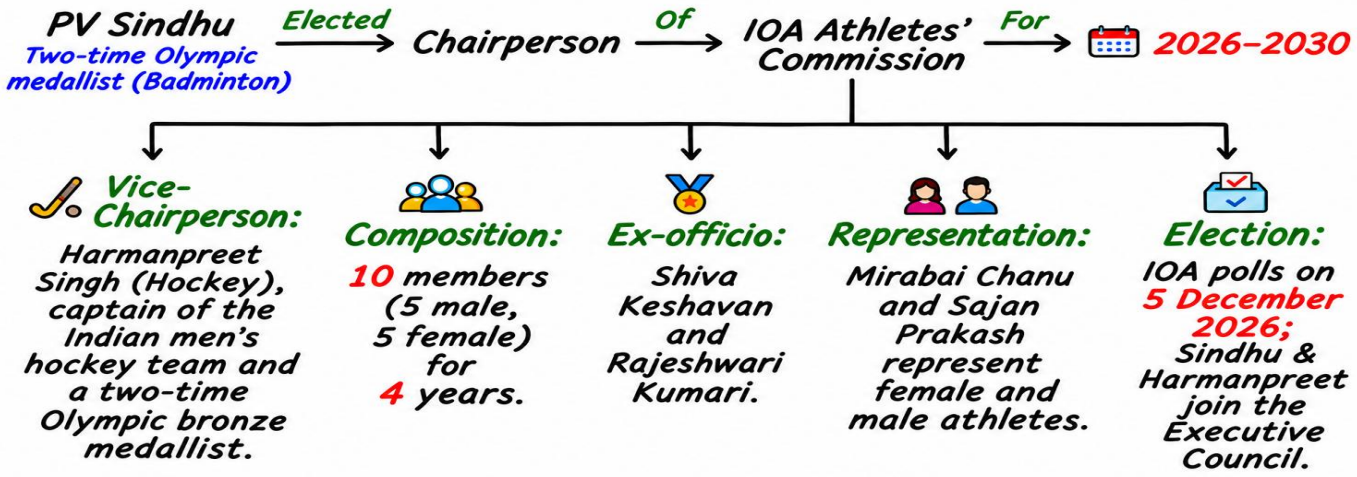
Prize Money: PHP 2.39 Million (Approx. GBP 30,000)
Technology: Self-Sensing Concrete
Components: Embedded Electrodes & Electronic Module
Data Transmission: Wireless Monitoring via Online Dashboard
Global Medical Winner: 'Rumble Rims'

Abbreviations

PHP – Philippine Peso
GBP – British Pound Sterling

APPOINTMENTS & RESIGNATIONS

1)



Abbreviation

IOA – Indian Olympic Association

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SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

1)

IAF's IL-76MD 'Gajraj' (Russian-origin) —Achieved→ The highest-altitude landing for its aircraft —Type→ Nyoma, Ladakh (13,629 ft)

- Runway: BRO-built, 2.7 km; Rs. 218 crore.
- Location: 25 km from the China's Line of Actual Control (LAC)
- Significance: Improves Army logistics and rapid response.

About IL-76MD Aircraft:

- Origin: Russian-origin, four-engine transport aircraft; inducted in 1985.

IAF – Indian Air Force

BRO – Border Roads Organisation

IL-76 - Ilyushin -76

ENVIRONMENT

1)

Liocheles Similipalensis (New Scorpion Species) —Discovered in→ Similipal Tiger Reserve, Odisha

Liocheles Similipalensis —Published in→ Euscorpius Journal

- Features: 44–53 mm; bluish-black body.
- Habitat: Rocky forests at 1,000 m.
- IN Diversity: 4th in India, 1st in Odisha; 7 globally.

SPORTS

1)

Brazilian Grand Prix 2026 (20th round of the F1 World Championship) —Held→ São Paulo, Brazil

Top 3 positions:

Rank	Driver	Brand	Country
1	Lando Norris	McLaren	United Kingdom
2	Max Verstappen	Red Bull Racing	Netherlands
3	Isack Hadjar	Red Bull Racing	France

Constructors' Title: Mercedes won its 9th F1 Constructors' Championship with 652 points, its first since 2021.

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👑 World Champion: Mercedes driver Andrea Kimi Antonelli had already secured the 2026 Drivers' Championship at the Mexican GP.

F1 – Formula One

GP – Grand Prix

2)

Sabbhineni Meghana (Indian top-order batter) —Announced→ Retirement from All formats of cricket —At→ Age of 30

⏳ Debut: T20I (2016); ODI (2022).

📊 Record: 17 T20Is (258 runs); 3 ODIs (114 runs).

🏅 Achievements: 2016 Asia Cup winner; 388 runs in 2021–22 Trophy; RCB's 2024 WPL

T20I – Twenty20 International

ODI – One Day International

WPL – Women's Premier League

RCB – Royal Challengers Bengaluru

OBITUARY

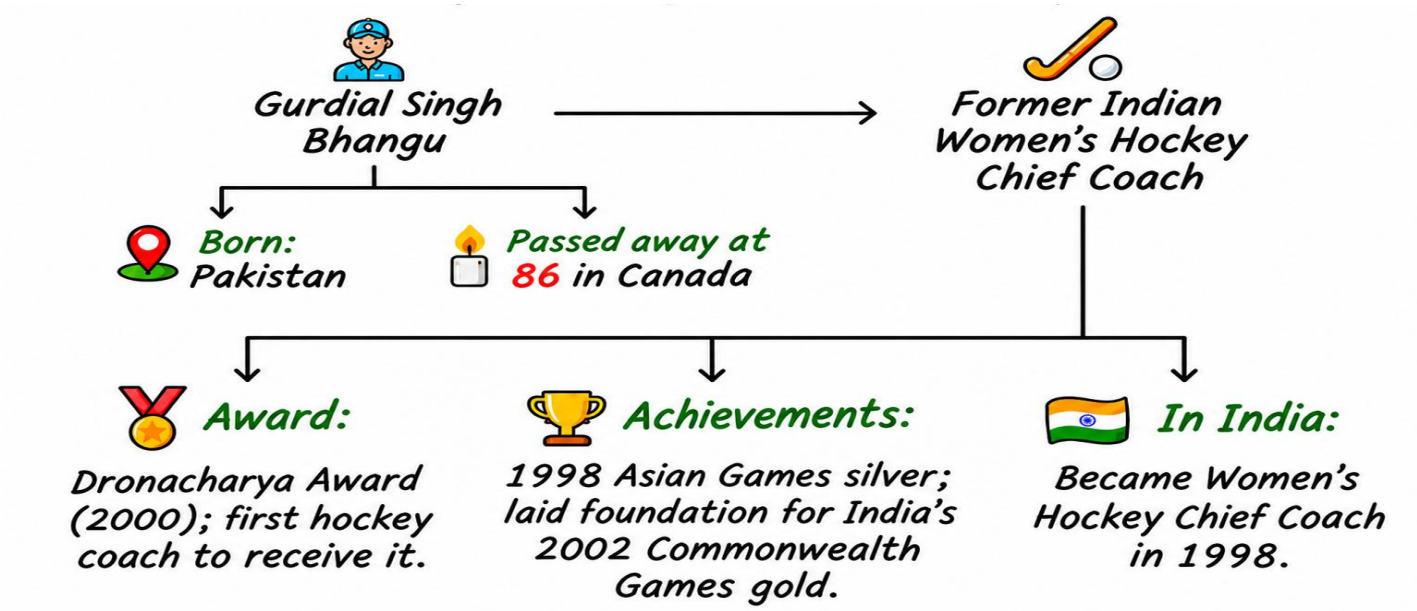
1)

Arpita Singh → Modernist Artist & Padma Bhushan Awardee

- Born: West Bengal
- Passed away at 89: New Delhi, Delhi
- → 2011 in the field of Arts
- → ⏳ Honours: Kalidas Samman (1998–99); Parishad Samman (1991); Lalit Kala Akademi Fellowship (2014).
- → 🖌 Works: Debi Pistol Wali (1990); The Eternal Repose (1997).

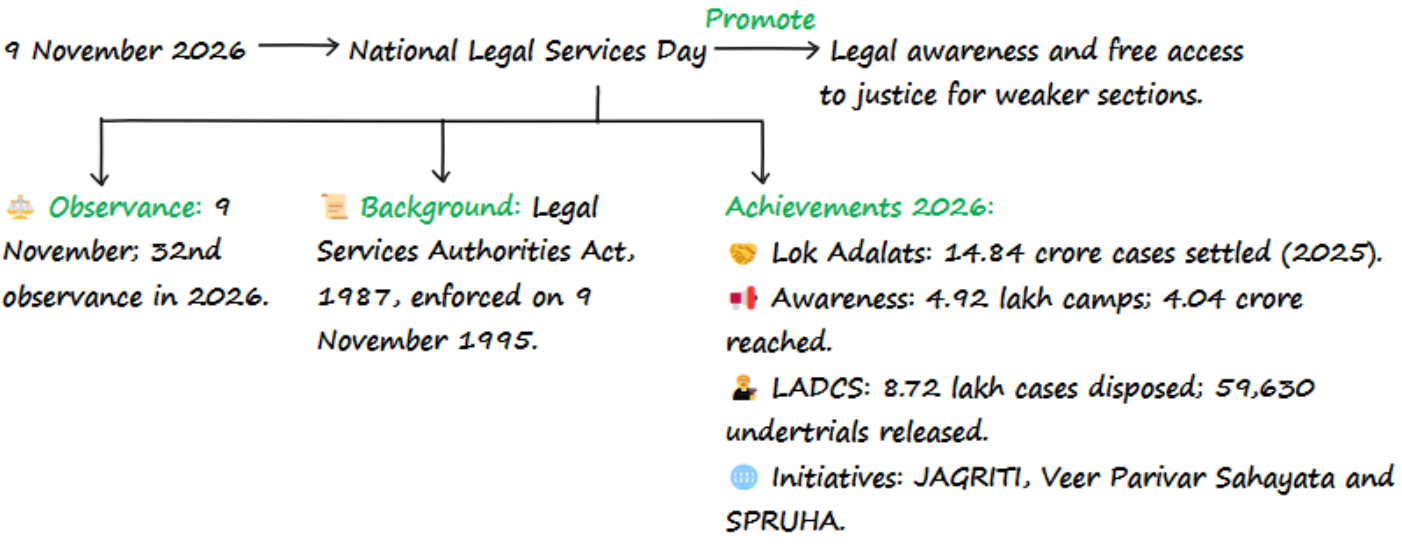
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2)



IMPORTANT DAYS

1)



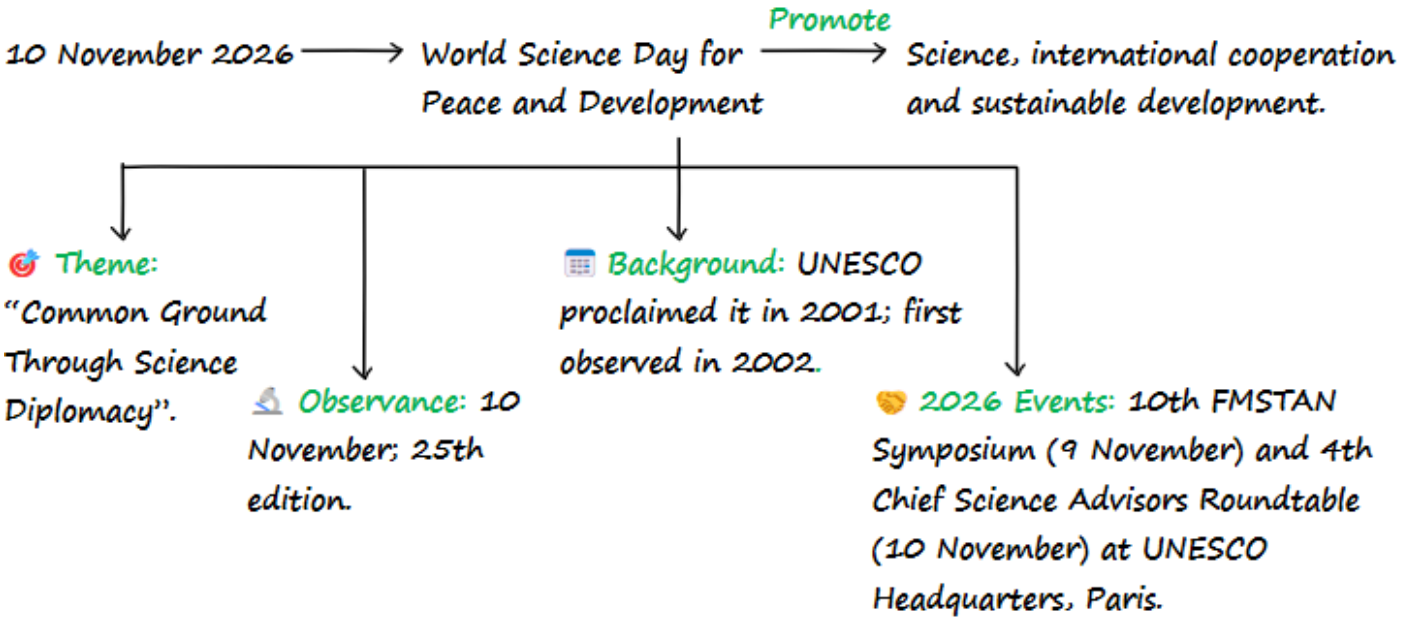
LADCS – Legal Aid Defence Counsel System

JAGRITI – Justice Awareness for Grassroots Information and Transparency Initiative

SPRUHA – Supporting Potential and Resilience of the Unseen, Held-back and Affected.

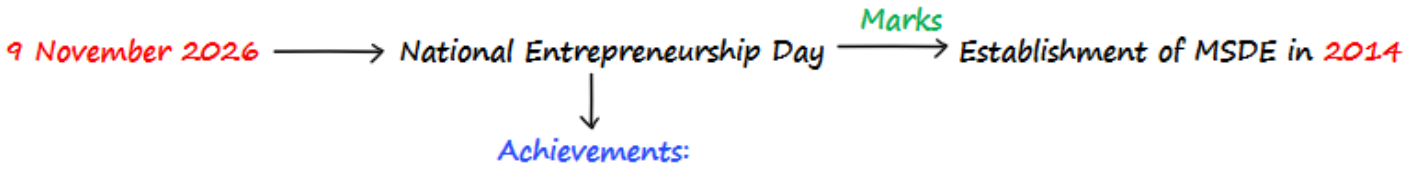
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2)



UNESCO – United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization FMSTAN – Foreign Ministries Science and Technology Advice Network

3)



🚀 Ecosystem: India is the world's 3rd-largest startup ecosystem, with 2.62 lakh+ DPIIT-recognised startups (November 2026), up from fewer than 500 in 2014.

👥 Youth: 65% of Indians are below 35 years.

📈 Growth: 55,200+ startups recognised in FY26; 25 lakh+ jobs generated.

🗺️ States: Maharashtra, Karnataka, Uttar Pradesh, Delhi and Gujarat.

👩 Women: 48% of startups have at least one woman director/partner.

🏙️ Inclusion: 52% of startups are from non-metro cities.

MSDE – Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship

DPIIT – Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade

FY – Financial Year

Detailed Content

Current Affairs 11 November 2026: Headlines



- India Re-elected as ISA President for the Third Consecutive Term
- WIPO's GII 2026: India Ranks 38th, Switzerland Retains Top Position
- INS Surat Participates in 15th Edition of India-Oman Maritime Exercise 'Naseem Al Bahr 2026' in Oman
- ADB Releases USD 21.6 Million First Tranche for Mizoram Healthcare Scheme
- IOB Launches 'IOB Digital Rupee' App with Programmable CBDC Facility
- ICICI Life Insurance Launches EzyGrow ULIP with 2X and 3X Premium Funding Benefits on Policybazaar
- France Honours Dr. Devi Shetty with 'Knight of the National Order of Merit' for COVID-19 Support
- Union Home Minister Amit Shah Confers President's Police Colour on Uttarakhand State Police
- Filipino Engineer Aldrei Ong Wins 2026 James Dyson Global Sustainability Award for Sentinel
- PV Sindhu Elected IOA Athletes' Commission Chairperson; Harmanpreet Singh Named Vice-Chairperson
- IAF's IL-76MD 'Gajraj' Sets World Record with Highest-Altitude Landing at Nyoma, Ladakh
- Researchers Discover New Scorpion Species 'Liocheles similipalensis' in Similipal Tiger Reserve, Odisha
- Brazilian Grand Prix 2026: Lando Norris Wins, Mercedes Clinches Constructors' Championship
- Indian Cricketer S Meghana Announces Retirement from All Formats of Cricket
- Modernist Artist & Padma Bhushan Awardee Arpita Singh Passed Away
- Former Indian Women's Hockey Chief Coach Gurdial Singh Bhangu Passed Away at 86
- National Legal Services Day 2026 – November 9
- World Science Day for Peace and Development 2026 – November 10
- National Entrepreneurship Day 2026 – 9 November

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NATIONAL AFFAIRS

India Re-elected as ISA President for the Third Consecutive Term

In November 2026, Union Minister **Pralhad Joshi**, Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE), announced that **India** was re-elected as the President of the International Solar Alliance **(ISA)** for the **2026–2028 term,** marking its third consecutive term, while **France** was re-elected as the **Co-President** of the ISA.

- The re-election took place during the ISA's 9th Session, held during Bharat Renewable Energy Summit and Expo 2026 in New Delhi, Delhi.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** India re-elected as President of ISA
- ✓ **Term:** 2026–2028 (two years)
- ✓ **Co-President:** France
- ✓ **Announced by:** Union Minister Pralhad Joshi, MNRE
- ✓ **ISA Established:** 30 November 2015.
- ✓ **Founding Countries:** India and France

Key Initiatives of ISA:

Solar Financing: Promote solar investments through the USD 200 million Africa Solar Facility and USD 300 million Nigeria Distributed Renewable Energy (DRE) Fund, while India committed Rs. 225 crore (USD 25 million) to expand affordable solar-energy access.

- The ISA also aims to support solar-powered agriculture and the global deployment of **1 million** solar pumps, drawing on India's Pradhan Mantri Kisan Urja Suraksha evam Utthaan Mahabhiyan (**PM-KUSUM)** scheme.



Island Solar Projects: Promote solar projects in **Fiji, Madagascar, Comoros and Seychelles**. Develop solar and energy-storage projects in **Mauritius** and achieve up to **500 MW** (Megawatt) of solar capacity in Small Island Developing States **(SIDS)** by **2030.**

Technology: Strengthen solar capabilities through **17** Solar Technology Application Resource Centres **(STAR-Cs)**, the SHINE Global Capability Centre and the AI-enabled ISA Academy.

About ISA: It was jointly launched by India and France on 30 November 2015, on the sidelines of the 21st Conference of the Parties (COP21) in Paris, France, to promote solar energy adoption and international cooperation under the "One Sun, One World, One Grid" (OSOWOG) principle, and had 130 signatory and member countries as of November 2026.

INTERNATIONAL AFFAIRS

WIPO's GII 2026: India Ranks 38th, Switzerland Retains Top Position

In November 2026, the World Intellectual Property Organisation **(WIPO)** released the **19th** edition of "Global Innovation Index (GII 2026): Powering entrepreneurs at the frontier of science". As per the index, **India** ranked at **38th** spot (same as previous year) with an overall score of **40.1.**

- **Switzerland** retained the 1st position (with an overall score of 66.7) in the GII 2026 for a 16th consecutive year. Sweden and the United States of America **(USA)** continued to secure 2nd and 3rd positions, respectively for the 4th consecutive year.

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Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Release of GII 2026
- ✓ **Edition:** 19th
- ✓ **Released by:** WIPO in collaboration with Portulans Institute
- ✓ **India Overall Rank:** 38th (overall score of 40.1)
- ✓ **World's Top 3 Innovative Countries:** Switzerland (ranks 1st); Sweden (ranks 2nd) and the USA (ranks 3rd)
- ✓ **Bottom 3 Countries:** Chad (139th); Niger (138th) and DRC (137th)
- ✓ **India-Specific:** Ranks 1st in LMI and Central/Southern Asia region
- ✓ **Innovation Clusters (from India):** 4, including Bengaluru (Karnataka)a; Delhi; Mumbai (Maharashtra) and Chennai (TN).

About Global Innovation Index (GII):

Index: The Gll was launched in 2007 by Professor Soumitra Dutta at INSEAD, with WIPO joining as a co-publisher in 2012 and becoming the sole publisher in 2021.

Evaluation: The GII evaluated the innovation performance of **139** world economies using **79 indicators**, ranging from Research & Development (R&D) spending, Venture Capital (VC) deals, high-tech exports and Intellectual Property Filings.

Sub-Indices: The GII comprises of two sub-indices:

- The **Innovation Input Sub-Index** which includes 5 pillars namely, Institutions; Human Capital and Research; Infrastructure; Market Sophistication; and Business Sophistication.
- While, the **Innovation Output Sub-Index** has 2 pillars i.e. Knowledge and Technology Outputs and Creative Outputs.

Top 5 Countries: GII 2026

Global Rank	Country Name	Overall Score
1	Switzerland	66.7
2	Sweden	63.2
3	The United States of America (USA)	62.3
4	Republic of Korea	61.4
5	Singapore	61.0
38	**India**	**40.1**

Bottom 5 Countries – GII 2026:

Global Rank	Country	Overall Score
135	Burundi	15.1
136	Angola	13.0
137	Democratic Republic of the Congo (DRC)	12.6
138	Niger	12.1

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139	Chad	9.5

Key Highlights:

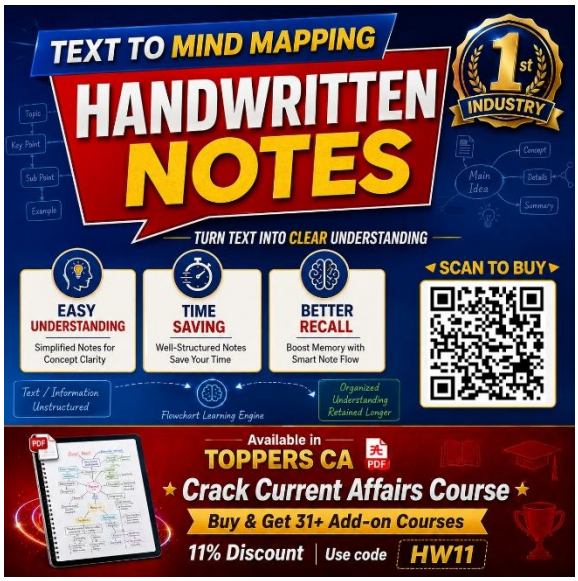
Other Top-Ranked Countries: The United Kingdom (UK) ranked 6th (59.6 points), followed by the Netherlands 7th (58.4), Finland 8th (57.9), Denmark 9th (57.7) and China 10th.

Global Research Output: As per the index, research output surpassed 2.4 million articles in 2025, registering a growth rate of 6.9% above its long-run trend.

Global R&D Expenditure: The index revealed that Global Research & Development (R&D) expenditure witnessed the growth of more than 3.3% in real terms in 2025. It is further projected to expand by 3.6% in 2026, reaching roughly **USD 3.4 trillion.**

VC Deals: The index further showed that VC deals values increased by nearly 28% to **USD 510 billion in 2025,** registering the strongest annual gain since 2021.

Most Innovative Region: Europe again emerged as the most innovative region in the index, featuring14 economies among top 25 innovative economies. The Kingdom of the Netherlands moves up to 7th spot and Austria to 18th spot.



Green-field R&D and high-tech FDI indicator: This year's index has introduced a green-field Research and Development (R&D) and high-tech Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) indicator, based on announced investment projects.

- **Total Investment Announcement:** Firms announced nearly 6,000 such projects in 2025 i.e. approximately 1/3rd of all green-field projects worldwide.
- **Top Investment Destinations:** As per the new indicator, the top 10 destinations attracted 58% of total projects, led by the USA, India and the UAE.

Bottom 5 Countries: Chad with an overall score of **9.5,** ranked lowest in the index; followed by Niger (ranked at 138th spot); Democratic Republic of Congo (DRC) (ranked at 137th spot); Angola (ranked at 136th spot); and Burundi (ranked at 135th spot).

India-Specific:

Region-wise: India **topped** among the 11 economies grouped in the **Central and Southern Asia region.** It is followed by Kazakhstan and Bhutan ranked at 2nd and 3rd positions, respectively.

Income-group: India ranked 1st among 36 economies featured in the Lower Middle-Income (LMI) group; followed by Viet Nam (ranked at 2nd spot) and the Philippines (ranked at 3rd spot).

India's Top Innovation Clusters: Bengaluru, Karnataka (ranked at 25th spot) emerged as the top-ranked cluster in India with a total of 8,022 PCT applications filed, 34,502 scientific articles published and 2,898 VC deals secured over a period of 5 years.

- It is followed by **Delhi** (ranked at 27th spot); **Mumbai,** Maharashtra (ranked at 43rd spot); and **Chennai,** Tamil Nadu (TN) (ranked at 79th spot).

Innovation Outputs and Inputs Performance: As per the index, India ranked at 49th spot in innovation inputs (up from last year) while it secured 25th spot in innovation outputs (up from last year).

About World Intellectual Property Organisation (WIPO):

Director-General **(DG) –** Daren Tang

Headquarters- Geneva, Switzerland

Established- 1967

INS Surat Participates in 15th Edition of India-Oman Maritime Exercise 'Naseem Al Bahr 2026' in Oman

In November 2026, the Indian Navy **(IN)** and the Royal Navy of Oman **(RNO)** commenced the **15th** edition of their bilateral maritime exercise **'Naseem Al Bahr' (Sea Breeze)** at Muscat, Oman, from **8th to 11th November 2026.**

- Indian Naval Ship **(INS) Surat** participated in the exercise, followed by a Coordinated Patrol (CORPAT), aimed at enhancing interoperability, exchanging operational experiences and strengthening mutual understanding between the two navies.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** 15th India-Oman bilateral maritime exercise Naseem Al Bahr (Sea Breeze)
- ✓ **Where?** Muscat, Oman
- ✓ **When?** 8–11 November 2026
- ✓ **Objective:** Enhance interoperability, exchange operational experiences and strengthen mutual understanding
- ✓ **Indian Participant:** Indian Naval Ship (INS) Surat.
- ✓ **Omani Participant:** Royal Navy of Oman.
- ✓ **Phases:** Harbour and sea phases
- ✓ **Activities:** Cross-deck visits, operational interactions and sporting events.



Background:

Origin: Naseem Al Bahr is a biennial bilateral maritime exercise between the IN and RNO, initiated in **1993,** to strengthen naval cooperation and maritime security.

Previous Edition: The **14th edition** of the exercise was conducted between the IN and the RNO off the coast of Goa from 13 to 18 October 2024, with India participating through INS Trikand and a Dornier Maritime Patrol Aircraft, while Oman deployed RNOV Al Seeb.

About Naseem Al Bahr 2026:

Aim: To strengthen maritime cooperation, enhance operational interoperability and deepen professional ties between the IN and the RNO.

Participants: India is represented by INS Surat, while Oman is represented by the RNO.

- INS Surat is the **fourth and final ship** of the Visakhapatnam, class guided-missile destroyers developed under Project 15B and was commissioned into the Indian Navy(IN) on 15 January 2025. It was built by Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL) with over 75% indigenous content.

Phases: The exercise comprises **two phases,**

- **Harbour Phase:** Personnel from both navies will participate in professional interactions, including cross-deck visits, operational interactions and sporting events. These engagements will facilitate the exchange of experiences and best practices.
- **Sea Phase:** Both navies will undertake operational engagements to enhance interoperability, strengthen coordination and develop mutual understanding.

Key Developments in Naseem Al Bahr 2026:

Defence Cooperation: The engagement builds on the momentum generated during the 13th India–Oman Joint Military Cooperation Committee (JMCC) meeting, held in New Delhi on 24 November 2025, co-chaired by India's Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh and Oman's Secretary General of the Ministry of Defence Dr. Mohammed bin Naseer bin Ali Al Zaabi.

Vision: INS Surat's visit aligns with India's **MAHASAGAR (**Mutual and Holistic Advancement for Security and Growth Across Regions) vision, which promotes maritime cooperation, regional security and growth.

About Oman:

Head of State and Government – Sultan Haitham bin Tariq
Capital- Muscat
Currency- Omani Rial

BANKING & FINANCE

ADB Releases USD 21.6 Million First Tranche for Mizoram Healthcare Scheme

In November 2026, the Asian Development Bank (**ADB**) released the first tranche of **USD 21.6 million** under its USD 108 million results-based loan to strengthen the Mizoram Universal Healthcare Scheme (**MUHCS**).

- On 29 October 2026, ADB transferred the amount to the Union Ministry of Finance (MoF) after Mizoram achieved two Disbursement-Linked Indicators (DLIs). Subsequently, the ministry transferred Rs 205.49 crore to Mizoram on 5 November 2026.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Releases First Tranche for Mizoram Healthcare Programme
- ✓ **Released by:** ADB
- ✓ **Amount Released:** USD 21.6 million
- ✓ **Purpose:** To support implementation of MUHCS
- ✓ **Funding Structure:** Rs 20.54 crore (10%) as loan and Rs 184.93 crore (90%) as grant
- ✓ **MUHCS Launched in:** 2025

Key Details:

Funding Structure: Of the total amount received by the state government, Rs **20.54 crore** (accounting for 10%), will be considered as a loan, while the remaining **Rs 184.93 crore** (accounting for 90%) as a grant.

- Also, the entire amount will be deposited in the state's **Healthcare Corpus Fund** to strengthen the financial sustainability of the scheme.

Key Target: The state government targets to achieve at least three DLIs during the current financial year i.e. Financial Year 2026-27 (FY27).

- It further plans to draw and use around Rs 130 crore under the programme.

About ADB-Supported Healthcare Project:

Project Approval: The ADB Board approved the programme on **5 December 2025**, and the loan agreement was signed on **23 January 2026**.

Project Implementation: The programme became effective on **2 April 2026** and is being executed by the **Finance Department, Government of Mizoram**.

Objective: Improve equitable access to affordable, high-quality healthcare services for approximately **1.38 million residents**, particularly women, older persons and Persons with Disabilities (PwDs).

About MUHCS:

Background: The scheme was launched in March 2025 and became operational on 1 April 2025.

Key Benefit: It provides eligible families with cashless healthcare coverage of up to Rs 5 lakh annually at government and empanelled private hospitals.

Monthly Contribution: As per the scheme, government employees (including, provisional and muster-roll employees), will have to pay a monthly contribution ranging **from Rs 200 to Rs 1,500** depending on their pay scales to avail unlimited health cover benefits.

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Other Conditions: Pensioners and their spouses can receive coverage of up to Rs 24 lakh per financial year by surrendering their monthly Fixed Medical Allowance (FMA) of Rs 1,000.
Exemption: Beneficiaries of Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB PM-JAY) are exempted from enrolment fees.

About Asian Development Bank (ADB):

President- Masato Kanda (Japan)
Headquarters- Mandaluyong City, Manila, the Philippines
Members Nations- 69 (50 members nations are from Asia-Pacific region)
Established- 1966

IOB Launches 'IOB Digital Rupee' App with Programmable CBDC Facility

In November 2026, Indian Overseas Bank (**IOB**), a public sector bank, launched its '**IOB Digital Rupee'** mobile application(app), enabling customers to make transactions using India's Central Bank Digital Currency (**CBDC**), with Programmable CBDC (**PCBDC**) functionality for purpose-specific disbursement of government grants and benefits.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Digital Rupee mobile application 'Digital Rupee' launched
- ✓ **Launched By:** IOB
- ✓ **Technology:** CBDC
- ✓ **Currency:** Digital Rupee (e₹)
- ✓ **Features:** Digital Rupee Wallet, P2P and P2M transactions, UPI
- ✓ **Additional Feature:** PCBDC.

About IOB Digital Rupee:

Features: The application allows customers to maintain Digital Rupee wallets(e₹) and supports Peer-to-Peer (**P2P**) and Peer-to-Merchant (**P2M**) transactions, along with Unified Payments Interface (**UPI**) interoperability through a secure, accessible and user-friendly mobile interface.
Applications: The PCBDC facility enables purpose-specific disbursement and utilisation of government funds, supporting efficient delivery of Direct Benefit Transfers (**DBT**), government-sponsored benefits and targeted financial assistance through CBDC.
Digital Rupee (e₹): RBI-issued CBDC, recognised as legal tender for digital payments. The retail pilot was launched on 1 December 2022.
About IOB: Established on 10 February 1937 by M. Ct. M. Chidambaram Chettyar, IOB is headquartered in Chennai, Tamil Nadu (TN), with the tagline "Good People to Bank With."

ICICI Life Insurance Launches EzyGrow ULIP with 2X and 3X Premium Funding Benefits on Policybazaar

In November 2026, **ICICI Life Insurance Limited** launched **ICICI Life EzyGrow,** a Unit-Linked Insurance Plan (ULIP) offering enhanced Waiver of Premium **(WOP) benefits of 2X and 3X,** under which the insurer funds twice or thrice the future pending premiums upon the death of the life assured.

- Distributed exclusively online through **Policybazaar,** the plan combines market-linked returns and family protection to support long-term financial goals, including children's education and retirement planning.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Launch of ICICI Life EzyGrow, a ULIP Plan
- ✓ **By Whom?** ICICI Life Insurance Limited
- ✓ **Key Feature:** Enhanced WOP with 1X, 2X and 3X future-premium funding options
- ✓ **Distribution:** Exclusive online distribution partnership with Policybazaar.

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- ✓ **Objective:** To maintain families' long-term financial goals, including children's education and spouses' retirement.

About ICICI Life EzyGrow:

Benefits: The plan provides a **Family Income Benefit** through additional yearly income for dependants, along with continued investment contributions, Maturity Boosters and the return of policy administration charges under specified conditions, while investment returns remain market-linked and non-guaranteed.
Retirement: The Retirement/Whole Life option supports retirement-corpus creation through a Systematic Withdrawal Plan (SWP) from any age, allowing fixed-amount or percentage-based withdrawals, subject to policy conditions.
Flexibility: The plan permits partial withdrawals, while nominees can continue managing the policy after the death of the Life Assured through permitted fund switches, premium redirection and partial withdrawals, subject to policy provisions.
Framework: ULIPs combine life insurance with market-linked investments, with investment risk borne by the policyholder and a five-year lock-in period for individual plans in India.

AWARDS & RECOGNITIONS

France Honours Dr. Devi Shetty with 'Knight of the National Order of Merit' for COVID-19 Support

In November 2026, the Government of **France** conferred the **Chevalier de l'Ordre national du Mérite** (Knight of the National Order of Merit) on **Dr. Devi Prasad Shetty**, Founder and Chairman of Narayana Health, in recognition of his support to the French community in Bengaluru, Karnataka during the **COVID-19 pandemic**.

- The honour was presented by Marc Lamy, Consul General of France in Bengaluru, at a ceremony held at Narayana Health City, Bengaluru.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** France conferred the Knight of the National Order of Merit
- ✓ **Award:** Chevalier de l'Ordre national du Mérite
- ✓ **Recipient:** Dr. Devi Prasad Shetty, Founder and Chairman of Narayana Health
- ✓ **Presented By:** Marc Lamy, Consul General of France
- ✓ **Recognition:** Support to the French community in Bengaluru during the COVID-19 pandemic.

About Dr. Devi Prasad Shetty:

Career: After completing his studies, he returned to India in 1989 and worked at B.M. Birla Hospital, Kolkata (West Bengal, WB), where he performed India's **first neonatal heart surgery i**n 1992 and later served as Mother Teresa's personal physician.

- He also founded the Rabindranath Tagore International Institute of Cardiac Sciences in Kolkata, West Bengal (WB).

Healthcare: He founded Narayana Hrudayalaya in Bengaluru in 2001 and promoted affordable healthcare through economies of scale and low-cost diagnostic services. He also developed the Yeshasvini health insurance scheme for Karnataka's farmers in collaboration with the State Government.
National Awards: He received the **Padma Shri** (2004), India's fourth-highest civilian award, and the **Padma Bhushan** (2012), India's third-highest civilian award, both in the field of Medicine.

- He also received the Karnataka Ratna (2001), Dr. B. C. Roy Award (2003), Sir M. Visvesvaraya Memorial Award (2003) and Schwab Foundation Award (2005).

International Recognition: He received the Entrepreneur of the Year Award (2003), The Economist Innovation Award (2011), an honorary degree from the University of Minnesota (2011), the Entrepreneur of

the Year Award (2012), Cable News Network–Indian Broadcasting Network (CNN-IBN) Indian of the Year (Public Sector) Award (2012) and an honorary Doctor of Science degree from the Indian Institute of Technology Madras (IIT-M) (2014).

About Knight of the National Order of Merit:

Establishment: The National Order of Merit (Ordre national du Mérite) was established on **3rd December 1963** by French President Charles de Gaulle.

- It is France's second-highest national order of distinction after the Legion of Honour and recognises distinguished contributions by French and foreign nationals in civilian and military fields.

Grades: The order comprises 5 grades: Knight, Officer, Commander, Grand Officer and Grand Cross.
Awarding Authority: The honour is conferred under the authority of the President of France

About France:

President – Emmanuel Macron
Capital – Paris
Currency – Euro (EUR).

Union Home Minister Amit Shah Confers President's Police Colour on Uttarakhand State Police

In November 2026, **Union Minister Amit Shah,** Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA), conferred the **President's Colour** to **Uttarakhand Police** during a ceremony held at state police lines in Dehradun, Uttarakhand.

- The award ceremony coincided with the silver jubilee (25th anniversary) of the formation of Uttarakhand state (on November 9, 2000).

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** President's Police Colour conferred
- ✓ **Recipient:** Uttarakhand Police
- ✓ **Conferred By:** Union Home Minister Amit Shah, MHA
- ✓ **Key Milestone:** 16th state in India to receive the highest honour

Key Details:

Key Milestone: Post this recognition, Uttarakhand became the **16th** state police force in India to receive this highest honour.
Key Dignitaries: Pushkar Singh Dhami, Chief Minister (CM) of Uttarakhand; Deepam Seth, Director General of Police (DGP) of Uttarakhand and other senior officials were also present at the event.
About the President's Colour: Also known as 'Rashtrapati Ka Nishan', it is the highest ceremonial honour bestowed upon military and police units for their exceptional service, discipline, valour and dedication to duty.

- The Indian Navy (IN) was the first Indian armed force to receive the President's Colour, on 27 May 1951.

Filipino Engineer Aldrei Ong Wins 2026 James Dyson Global Sustainability Award for Sentinel

In November 2026, Filipino structural engineer **Aldrei Ong** won the 2026 **James Dyson Global Sustainability Award** for developing **Sentinel**, a low-cost sensor that detects hidden damage in concrete structures after earthquakes.

- He received PHP (Philippine Peso) 2.39 million (approximately **GBP (British Pound Sterling) 30,000**) in prize money.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Filipino Engineer won James Dyson Award
  Who? Aldrei Ong, a Filipino structural engineer.
- ✓ **Award:** 2026 James Dyson Global Sustainability Award.

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- ✓ **Winning Invention:** Sentinel.
- ✓ **Purpose:** Detects hidden structural damage in concrete buildings after earthquakes.
- ✓ **Prize Money:** PHP 2.39 million (approximately £30,000).

Highlights of the Invention:

Invention: Sentinel converts a conventional concrete spacer block into a sensor that detects hidden cracks through changes in electrical resistance using self-sensing concrete.

- The device uses embedded electrodes and an electronic module to detect resistance variations and wirelessly send data to an online dashboard for remote monitoring.

Development: Ong tested over **125 concrete samples** and installed sensors in a Philippine building; he plans further validation and versions for existing buildings.

Significance: Sentinel aims to improve post-earthquake building safety; the 2026 competition received **2,294 entries from 28 countries** and regions, marking the return of the award to the Philippines after its 2020 win by Carvey Ehren Maigue.

Other Global Medical Winner: 'Rumble Rims', developed by Radhika Saran, Cleo Pontone and Sophia DeVito from Harvard University, United States of America (USA).

APPOINTMENTS & RESIGNATIONS

PV Sindhu Elected IOA Athletes' Commission Chairperson; Harmanpreet Singh Named Vice-Chairperson

On **6 November 2026**, the Indian Olympic Association **(IOA)** elected **PV Sindhu** (Badminton), a **two-time Olympic medallist** (silver at Rio 2016, Brazil and bronze at Tokyo 2020, Japan), as **Chairperson** of its Athletes' Commission for the **2026–2030** term.

- **Harmanpreet Singh** (Hockey), captain of the Indian men's hockey team and a two-time Olympic bronze medallist (Tokyo 2020, Japan and Paris 2024, France), was elected **Vice-Chairperson** for the same term.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** IOA Athletes' Commission elections
- ✓ **Organisation:** Indian Olympic Association (IOA)
- ✓ **Term:** 2026–2030
- ✓ **Composition:** 10 members (five male and five female athletes)
- ✓ **Chairperson:** PV Sindhu (Badminton)
- ✓ **Vice-Chairperson:** Harmanpreet Singh (Hockey)
- ✓ **General Assembly Representatives:** Mirabai Chanu (Weightlifting) and Sajan Prakash (Swimming)

About IOA Athletes' Commission:

Composition: It comprises 10 elected members (five male and five female athletes) for a four-year term, with Salima Tete (Hockey), Swapnil Kusale (Shooting), Bhavani Devi (Fencing), Tajinderpal Singh Toor (Athletics – Shot Put), Bombayla Devi (Archery), Manjeet Singh (Rowing), PV Sindhu, Harmanpreet Singh, Mirabai Chanu (Weightlifting) and Sajan Prakash (Swimming) elected unopposed.

- Winter Olympian **Shiva Keshavan** and shooter **Rajeshwari Kumari,** associated with the Olympic Council of Asia (OCA) Athletes' Commission, will serve as **ex-officio members**.

Executive Council: PV Sindhu and Harmanpreet Singh will join the IOA Executive Council after the December 2026 elections but will not occupy the two General Body voting positions.

Representation: Mirabai Chanu (Weightlifting) and **Sajan Prakash** (Swimming) were elected unopposed to represent female and male athletes, respectively, in the IOA General Assembly and will exercise voting rights in the IOA elections scheduled for 5 December 2026.

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About the IOA: Established in 1927 and recognised by the International Olympic Committee (IOC), the IOA is the national body responsible for promoting and governing the Olympic Movement in India, with its headquarters in New Delhi, Delhi.

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

IAF's IL-76MD 'Gajraj' Sets World Record with Highest-Altitude Landing at Nyoma, Ladakh

In November 2026, the Indian Air Force (IAF)'s Russian-origin **Ilyushin IL-76MD 'Gajraj',** a heavy-lift transport aircraft, achieved the world's highest-altitude landing for its aircraft type at **Mudh-Nyoma Airbase** in eastern Ladakh, situated at 13,629 feet (approximately 4,154 metres(m)) above sea level.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** IAF sets World's highest-altitude landing
- ✓ **Aircraft:** IL-76MD aircraft (Russian Origin)
- ✓ **Operated By:** IAF
- ✓ **Location:** Mudh-Nyoma Airbase, eastern Ladakh
- ✓ **Altitude:** 13,629 feet.

Key Details of Milestone:

Background: The upgradation of the airbase and runway was approved by the Government of India (GoI) after the military standoff with China in 2020.

- The Border Roads Organisation (BRO) had constructed a 2.7 kilometer (km)-long runway with a cost of Rs 218 crore.

Inauguration: The airbase station was formally inaugurated by former IAF Chief Marshal Amar Preet Singh (retd.) in November 2025, after the successful landing of C-130J special operations aircraft there.

Strategic Location: The airbase is situated nearly 25 kilometers (kms) from the Line of Actual Control (LAC) with China.

Significance: The direct landing of heavy-lift transports at Advance High-Altitude Landing Grounds (ALGs) is expected to reduce response times and enhance logistic support to the Army at the remote areas of Ladakh.

About IL-76MD Aircraft:

Overview: A Russian-origin, four-engine heavy-lift aircraft inducted into the IAF on **16 June 1985**, making it one of its oldest strategic airlift assets, used for transporting troops, vehicles, cargo and humanitarian supplies.

Payload Capacity: It has the capability to carry **40-45 tonnes,** depending on configuration and operating conditions, including heavy platforms such as: tanks and BMPs.

Key Application: It is specifically designed to transport personnel and essential supplies to remote and strategically important locations.

Future Plan: IAF through its Medium Transport Aircraft programme is planning to replace both IL-76 and AN-32 fleets.

About Indian Air Force (IAF):

Chief of Air Staff **(CoAS)-** Air Chief Marshal Ashutosh Dixit
Motto- Nabha Sparsham Deeptam (Touch the Sky with Glory)
Headquarters- New Delhi, Delhi
Established- 1932

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ENVIRONMENT

Researchers Discover New Scorpion Species 'Liocheles similipalensis' in Similipal Tiger Reserve, Odisha

In November 2026, researchers discovered a new scorpion species, '**Liocheles similipalensis'**, named after Similipal Tiger Reserve (TR) in Mayurbhanj district, Odisha. The discovery was published in the scientific journal **Euscorpius.**

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** New scorpion species discovered
- ✓ **Species:** Liocheles similipalensis
- ✓ **Location:** Similipal Tiger Reserve, Mayurbhanj district, Odisha
- ✓ **Genus:** Liocheles
- ✓ **Appearance:** Glossy, bluish-black body
- ✓ **Habitat:** Rocky areas within tropical moist deciduous forests
- ✓ **Total Recognised Species:** Seven.

About Liocheles similipalensis:

Discovery: The discovery involved researchers Saurabh Kininge, Tejas Thackeray and Akshay Khandekar, along with Dr. Prakash Chand Gogineni, Field Director of Similipal TR, through collaboration between the Thackeray Wildlife Foundation (TWF) and Similipal Tiger reserve officials.

Features: The scorpion measures **44–53 millimetres** (mm) in length and has a glossy, bluish-black body. Its identification was based on distinctive morphological features, including minute hair-like structures called setae beneath the second segment of its leg tarsus, variations in body ridges and surface textures, and differences in median-eye proportions.

Habitat: It was found in rocky habitats within tropical moist deciduous forests at approximately **1,000 metres** (m) above sea level, with Similipal remaining its only confirmed habitat.

Diversity: It is the fourth species of the genus Liocheles recorded in India and the first in Odisha, bringing the total number of recognised species in the genus to seven.

SPORTS

Brazilian Grand Prix 2026: Lando Norris Wins, Mercedes Clinches Constructors' Championship

In November 2026, **Lando Norris,** a British Formula One (**F1**) driver representing **McLaren**, won the **2026 F1 Brazilian Grand Prix** (**GP**) (São Paulo GP), held on 8 November 2026 at the Autódromo José Carlos Pace (Interlagos) in São Paulo, Brazil, securing his **third** victory of the season.

- Norris defeated Dutch driver **Max Verstappen** of Red Bull Racing by 14.602 seconds, while **Isack Hadjar** of Red Bull Racing finished third.
- **Mercedes** clinched the **2026 F1 Constructors' World Championship** with 652 points, securing its **ninth** overall title and first since 2021, followed by Ferrari (512 points) and Red Bull (415 points).

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** 2026 Brazilian Grand Prix (Round 20 of the 2026 F1 season)
- ✓ **Where?** Autódromo José Carlos Pace (Interlagos), São Paulo, Brazil
- ✓ **Winner:** Lando Norris (McLaren)
- ✓ **Norris's Win:** Third of the 2026 season
- ✓ **Podium:** Max Verstappen (Red Bull Racing, 2nd), Isack Hadjar(Red Bull Racing, 3rd)

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✓ **Constructors' Champions:** Mercedes (652 points)

About Brazilian Grand Prix 2026:

Overview: 2026 Brazilian GP, the **20th** round of the F1 World Championship, featured changing weather conditions, multiple spins and position changes, while Lewis Hamilton finished ninth in his 400th Formula One start.

Championship: Mercedes driver **Andrea Kimi Antonelli** finished fifth, having already secured the 2026 World Drivers' Championship at the Mexican Grand Prix.

Podium Breakthrough: Isack Hadjar secured his third podium finish of the 2026 season, having previously finished third at the Monaco GP in June 2026 and the Azerbaijan GP in September 2026.

Retirements / DNS: Lance Stroll (Aston Martin) retired on Lap 22, while Valtteri Bottas (Cadillac) Did Not Start (DNS) due to a wheel-nut failure.

Top 3 positions of F1 Brazilian Grand Prix 2026

Rank	Driver	Brand	Country
1	Lando Norris	McLaren	United Kingdom (UK)
2	Max Verstappen	Red Bull Racing	Netherlands
3	Isack Hadjar	Red Bull Racing	France

Top 5 Drivers – Championship Standings After Brazilian Grand Prix 2026

Rank	Driver	Team	Points
1	Kimi Antonelli	Mercedes AMG Petronas F1	390
2	Max Verstappen	Red Bull Racing	279
3	George Russell	Mercedes AMG Petronas F1	262
4	Lewis Hamilton	Scuderia Ferrari HP	261
5	Charles Leclerc	Scuderia Ferrari HP	249

About Brazilian Grand Prix:

Overview: First held as a non-championship event in 1972, the Brazilian GP entered the official Fédération Internationale de l'Automobile (FIA) F1 World Championship calendar in 1973, won by Brazilian driver Emerson Fittipaldi.

- It has been officially known as the São Paulo Grand Prix since 2021.

About Autódromo José Carlos Pace: Originally known as **Interlagos** (Portuguese for "between lakes") and was renamed in 1985 in honour of Brazilian F1 driver José Carlos Pace.

Circuit Specifications: The circuit is 4.309 km (kilometres) long, runs anti-clockwise and hosts a 71-lap race covering a total distance of 305.879 km.

Indian Cricketer S Meghana Announces Retirement from All Formats of Cricket

In October 2026, Indian top-order batter **Sabbhineni Meghana** announced her retirement from all formats of cricket at the age of 30, ending her playing career after representing India in international cricket and featuring in the Women's Premier League (WPL).

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Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Announced retirement from all formats of cricket
- ✓ **Who?** S Meghana
- ✓ **International Matches:** 20 (3 ODIs and 17 T20Is)
- ✓ **International Runs:** 372
- ✓ **WPL Teams:** Gujarat Giants and Royal Challengers Bengaluru
- ✓ **Major Achievement:** Member of RCB's 2024 Women's Premier League (WPL) title-winning squad.

About S Meghana:

Profile: Sabbhineni Meghana, a right-handed Indian batter from Krishna district, Andhra Pradesh (AP), represented India internationally and played for Andhra, South Zone and Railways in domestic cricket.
Achievements: She made her Twenty20 International (T20I) debut against West Indies in 2016 and One Day International (ODI) debut against New Zealand in 2022, playing **17 T20Is and 3 ODIs.**

- She was part of India's 2016 Women's T20 Asia Cup-winning team, topped the 2021–22 Women's Senior One Day Trophy with 388 runs, and was selected for the 2022 Commonwealth Games squad and as a reserve for the 2022 Women's Cricket World Cup.

Performance: She scored 114 runs in ODIs and 258 runs in T20Is, recording a half-century in each format.
League Career: She represented Trailblazers in 2022 and Gujarat Giants in the 2023 Women's Premier League, before joining Royal Challengers Bengaluru (RCB) in 2024. She was part of RCB's title-winning squad in the 2024 Women's Premier League.

OBITUARY

Modernist Artist & Padma Bhushan Awardee Arpita Singh Passed Away

In November 2026, renowned Indian modernist artist **Arpita Singh,** widely known for her detailed figurative works, passed away at the age of **89** in New Delhi, Delhi. She was born on **June 22, 1937** in Baranagar, then part of Bengal Province during British rule (now known as West Bengal, WB).

- In **2011**, the Government of India (GoI) honoured her with **Padma Bhushan,** India's 3rd highest civilian honour in the field of 'Arts'.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Famous Modernist artist passed away
- ✓ **Who?** Arpita Singh
- ✓ **Key Honours:** Padma Bhushan (2011)
- ✓ **Artistic Style:** Indian miniature painting, folk traditions, Kantha embroidery, among others
- ✓ **Notable Work:** Debi Pistol Wali (1990), and the Eternal Repose (1997).

About Arpita Singh:

Artistic Style: With a career spanning 6 decades, Arpita Singh's artistic work was mainly focused on Indian miniature painting, folk traditions, Kantha embroidery and modernist influences.
Notable Work: Some of her previous art works included surrealist landscapes, a period of pure abstraction focused on dots and lines. Later, she transitioned to creating oil paintings that are charged with emotion like: Debi Pistol Wali (1990), and the Eternal Repose (1997)
Global Representation: Her artworks has been showcased at various global platforms: the Royal Academy of Arts in London (the United Kingdom, UK), Paris (France); the Centre Georges Pompidou, the Art Gallery of New South Wales (in Sydney, Australia) and (in Geneva, Switzerland).

- In 2025, she organised her career's 1st solo institutional exhibition outside India, Remembering at Serpentine Galleries in London, the UK.

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Accolades: She was honoured with several national awards/honours which included: Fellowship of the Lalit Kala Akademi (2014); Kalidas Samman (1998-99)and Parishad Samman (1991).

Former Indian Women's Hockey Chief Coach Gurdial Singh Bhangu Passed Away at 86

In November 2026, **Gurdial Singh Bhangu,** former Chief Coach of the Indian Women's Hockey Team and Dronacharya Award recipient, passed away at the age of 86 in Surrey, Canada. He was born on 3 October 1941 in Lyallpur (now Faisalabad, Pakistan).

- He received the **Dronacharya Award,** India's highest sports coaching honor**,** in **2000**, becoming the first hockey coach to receive the prestigious national coaching award.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Former Indian Women's Hockey Chief Coach passed away
- ✓ **Who?** Gurdial Singh Bhangu
- ✓ **Award:** Dronacharya Award (2000) (First Coach)
- ✓ **Achievement:** Guided India to its maiden women's hockey gold medal at 2002 Commonwealth Games.

About Gurdial Singh Bhangu:

Early Life: He played hockey at the university level and joined the National Institute of Sports (NIS), Patiala, Punjab, in 1965, where he trained under hockey legends Major Dhyan Chand and Balkishan Singh.
Coaching Career: Between 1972 and 1976, he served as chief coach of the Nigerian women's hockey team, guiding Nigeria to its first Women's Hockey World Cup qualification in 1976.

- He took charge as chief coach of the Indian women's hockey team in **1998**, following India's 12th-place finish at the Women's Hockey World Cup.

Achievements: Under his guidance, India won the silver medal at the 1998 Asian Games in Bangkok, Thailand, laying the foundation for its historic 2002 Commonwealth Games gold medal in Manchester, England.

IMPORTANT DAYS

National Legal Services Day 2026 – November 9

National Legal Services Day **(NLSD)** is observed annually across India on **9 November** to commemorate the enforcement of the **Legal Services Authorities Act, 1987**, on 9 November 1995, and to promote legal awareness and equal access to justice, especially for disadvantaged sections.

- 9 November 2026 marks the **32nd** observance of NLSD.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** National Legal Services Day 2026
- ✓ **When?** 9 November, 2026
- ✓ **Edition:** 32nd
- ✓ **Commemorates:** Enforcement of the Legal Services Authorities Act, 1987, on 9 November 1995
- ✓ **Organising Body:** National Legal Services Authority
- ✓ **Proposed by:** Dr. Justice A.S. Anand, then Executive Chairman of NALSA
- ✓ **First Observance:** 9 November 1995.

Background:

Proposal: The annual observance of NLSD was proposed by **Dr. Justice A.S. Anand,** then Executive Chairman of NALSA, during the First Annual Meet held on **12 September 1998** at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi, Delhi.
First Observance: The first NLSD was observed on **9th November 1995**.

About Legal Services Authorities Act, 1987:

Act: Enacted in **October 1987**, the Legal Services Authorities Act aims to provide free and competent legal services to eligible weaker sections of society and ensure equal access to justice.

Constitutional Basis: The Act gives effect to **Article 39A** of the Constitution, which provides for equal justice and free legal aid.

Institutional Framework: The Act established a three-tier legal services structure comprising National Legal Services Authority (NALSA) at the national level (Patron-in-Chief: Chief Justice of India [CJI]), State Legal Services Authorities (SLSAs) at the state level (Patron-in-Chief: respective High Court Chief Justice) and District Legal Services Authorities (DLSAs) at the district level (Chairperson: District Judge).

Patron-in-Chief: The senior judicial authority who provides institutional leadership, guidance and support to the respective Legal Services Authority.

Achievements of Legal Services Authorities 2026:

Free Legal Aid: Provided free legal aid and advice to **16.60 lakh** persons during FY 2025–26 (up to January 2026).

Lok Adalats: State Lok Adalats settled **7.25 lakh** cases and Permanent Lok Adalats **2.33 lakh** cases up to January 2026. National Lok Adalats settled 14.84 crore cases during 2025.

Legal Awareness: Organised **4.92 lakh** awareness camps and programmes, reaching 4.04 crore participants up to January 2026.

Specialised Legal Aid Initiatives:

- **LADCS** (Legal Aid Defence Counsel System): Disposed of **8.72 lakh** cases out of 12.63 lakh assigned cases and facilitated the release of 59,630 undertrial prisoners.
- **JAGRITI** (Justice Awareness for Grassroots Information and Transparency Initiative)**:** Established **690 District** Units, 2,129 Taluk Units and over 35,000 Permanent Legal Aid Clinics, reaching 35.24 lakh persons.
- **Veer Parivar Sahayata Yojana**: Assisted 5,219 defence personnel, ex-servicemen and dependents through 417 Legal Aid Clinics.

- **SPRUHA (Supporting Potential and Resilience of the Unseen, Held-back and Affected):** Provides legal aid, counselling, rehabilitation and reintegration support to prisoners, undertrial inmates and their dependents.

About National Legal Services Authority (NALSA):

NALSA formulates policies and schemes for free legal aid, coordinates and monitors legal services programmes, allocates funds, promotes legal awareness and facilitates dispute resolution through Lok Adalats.

Patron-in-Chief – Justice Surya Kant – Chief Justice of India (CJI)
Headquarters – New Delhi, Delhi
Established – 1995

World Science Day for Peace and Development 2026 – November 10

The United Nations **(UN)**'s **World Science Day for Peace and Development** is observed annually across the globe on **10 November**, under the auspices of the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization **(UNESCO)**, to highlight the significant role of science in society and engage the wider public in debates on emerging scientific issues.

- 10 November 2026 marks the **25th edition**, observed during the International Decade of Sciences for Sustainable Development (2024–2033), led by UNESCO.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** World Science Day for Peace and Development
- ✓ **When?** November 10, 2026

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- ✓ **Edition:** 25th
- ✓ **2026 Theme:** "Common Ground Through Science Diplomacy
- ✓ **Declared By:** UNESCO in 2001
- ✓ **First Observed:** 10 November 2002
- ✓ **Linked Initiative:** International Decade of Sciences for Sustainable Development (2024–2033)
- ✓ **IWOSP:** 9–15 November 2026

Theme:

2026 Theme: "Common Ground Through Science Diplomacy"

Focus: Highlights the role of science diplomacy in building bridges across borders, promoting international dialogue and cooperation, and addressing shared global challenges.

Background:

Declaration: UNESCO proclaimed the observance in 2001, with the first celebration held on 10 November 2002.

First Observance: World Science Day for Peace and Development was first observed on 10 November 2002.

International Decade: In August 2023, the United Nations General Assembly **(UNGA)** proclaimed 2024–2033 as the International Decade of Sciences for Sustainable Development, led by UNESCO.

International Week of Science and Peace (IWOSP) 2026:

Observance: The IWOSP is observed annually from **9–15** November to promote science and technology for peace and international security.

Origin and Recognition: First observed in **1986** during the International Year of Peace and recognised by the UNGA in **1988** through Resolution 43/61.

UNESCO Kalinga Prize for the Popularization of Science:

Establishment: Instituted in 1951 following a donation by Bijoyanand Patnaik, Founder and President of India's Kalinga Foundation Trust. It is UNESCO's oldest prize, awarded biennially.

Award: Recognises contributions to science communication and carries USD 40,000, a certificate and the UNESCO-Albert Einstein Silver Medal.

- **Funding:** Kalinga Foundation Trust, Government of Odisha and Government of India (GoI), through the Department of Science and Technology (DST).

2023 Awardee: Professor Ana María Cetto (Mexico), recognised for promoting public access to scientific knowledge.

2026 Event Highlights:

ISC Initiative: The International Science Council (ISC) encouraged science diplomacy activities, including webinars, workshops, expert discussions and exhibitions.

FMSTAN Symposium: The 10th Anniversary Symposium of the Foreign Ministries Science and Technology Advice Network (FMSTAN) was held on 9 November 2026 at UNESCO Headquarters, Paris, France, under the theme "Reinventing Science Diplomacy in a Changing World", with European Commission support.

Fourth CSAR: The Fourth Chief Science Advisors Roundtable (CSAR) was organised by UNESCO and South Africa, with India's support, on 10 November 2026 at UNESCO Headquarters under the theme "Trusted Advice in a World of Plural Knowledge."

About United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO):

Director-General **(DG) –** Khaled El-Enany (Egypt)

Headquarters – Paris, France

Established – 1945

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National Entrepreneurship Day 2026 – November 9

National Entrepreneurship Day is observed annually across India on **9 November** to commemorate the establishment of the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship **(MSDE)** on **9 November 2014** and highlighting entrepreneurship as a key driver of India's development journey towards **Viksit Bharat 2047**.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** National Entrepreneurship Day 2026
- ✓ **When?** 9 November 2026
- ✓ **Commemoration:** Establishment of MSDE(2014)
- ✓ **Objective:** Promoting entrepreneurship as a driver of Viksit Bharat 2047
- ✓ **India's Ranking:** Third-largest startup ecosystem globally after USA & China.
- ✓ **Recognised Startups:** More than 2.62 lakh as of November 2026.

About India's Startup Ecosystem:

Startup Ecosystem: India is the world's **third-largest startup ecosystem**, with more than 2.62 lakh Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)-recognised startups as of November 2026, compared with fewer than 500 in 2014, after United States of America **(USA)** and **China.**

Youth: Nearly 65% of India's population is below 35 years, with the youth, referred to as the Amrit Peedhi, transforming from beneficiaries of development programmes into active entrepreneurs, job creators and contributors to national development.

Growth: More than 55,200 startups were recognised during Financial Year 2025–26 (FY26), the highest annual recognition since 2016, registering a 51.6% year-on-year increase, while startups generated over 25 lakh direct jobs up to October 2026, with direct job creation increasing by 36.1% during FY26.

- **Maharashtra, Karnataka, Uttar Pradesh (UP), Delhi** and **Gujarat w**ere among the leading regions in startup recognition and employment generation.

Inclusion: More than 1.07 lakh recognised startups (approximately 48%) have at least one woman director or partner, while around 52% originate from non-metro cities, reflecting the growing participation of women and entrepreneurs from smaller cities.

About Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship (MSDE):

Union Minister of State **(MoS)** (Independent Charge, IC) – Jayant Chaudhary (Rajya Sabha member- Uttar Pradesh, UP)



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- Chirag Paswan launches revamped Food Processing Ministry website
- Sports Department launches 'Khelo Bharat' quiz on MY Bharat portal; entries open till November 20
- Hindustan Zinc launches two new value-added products
- Sports journalist Bhasi Malaparamba no more

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